PRIMARY FIVE · TERM ONE · WEEK 2 · LESSON 1

Irregular Verbs

Name: _____ **Class:** _____ **Date:** _____

What you will learn

By the end of this lesson, you should be able to:

1. identify irregular verbs;
2. name their **base**, **past-simple** and **past-participle** forms; and
3. use the past simple and past participle correctly in sentences.

1. What is a verb?

A **verb** is a word that shows an action or a state. For example: *run, eat, write, go, be*.

Some verbs are **regular**. We usually add **-ed** or **-d** to make their past-simple and past-participle forms.

Base form	Past simple	Past participle
play	played	played
clean	cleaned	cleaned
love	loved	loved

Irregular verbs do not all follow this **-ed** pattern. Their past forms may change in different ways. Some do not change at all.

- *go* → *went* → *gone* (all three forms are different)
- *buy* → *bought* → *bought* (the last two forms are the same)
- *cut* → *cut* → *cut* (all three forms are the same)

2. Common irregular verbs

Read each row from left to right. The third column is the past participle, not another name for the past simple.

No.	Base form	Past simple	Past participle
1	be	was / were	been
2	begin	began	begun
3	break	broke	broken
4	bring	brought	brought

No.	Base form	Past simple	Past participle
5	buy	bought	bought
6	come	came	come
7	cut	cut	cut
8	do	did	done
9	drink	drank	drunk
10	drive	drove	driven
11	eat	ate	eaten
12	fall	fell	fallen
13	find	found	found
14	get	got	got
15	give	gave	given
16	go	went	gone
17	have	had	had
18	know	knew	known
19	make	made	made
20	read	read	read
21	run	ran	run
22	see	saw	seen
23	sing	sang	sung
24	take	took	taken
25	write	wrote	written

Remember: *read* is spelt the same in all three forms, but its past forms are pronounced like *red*.

3. When do we use each form?

Base form

The **base form** is the dictionary form of the verb. We often use it after *to* and after *can*.

- I want **to write** a letter.
- Amina can **sing** well.

Past simple

Use the **past-simple** form for an action completed in the past. You may see time words such as *yesterday, last week* or *this morning* (when the morning has finished).

- Yesterday, Musa **went** to the market.
- Our teacher **gave** us an exercise last Friday.
- The pupils **wrote** their names on the books.

Do not add *has*, *have* or *had* before a past-simple form in these examples.

Past participle

Use the **past participle** after **has**, **have** or **had** in the verb patterns we are practising.

- **Has + past participle:** Sarah **has eaten** her lunch.
- **Have + past participle:** The children **have gone** home.
- **Had + past participle:** By the time the bell rang, I **had finished** my work. (*Finished* is regular.)
- **Had + irregular past participle:** By the time the rain started, Father **had driven** to town.

Compare carefully:

Past simple	Has / have / had + past participle
I **saw** the bird yesterday.	I **have seen** that bird before.
Joan **broke** the cup.	Joan **has broken** the cup.
We **took** the books.	We **have taken** the books.
He **did** his homework.	He **has done** his homework.

4. Common mistakes and corrections

Incorrect	Correct	Why?
She **goed** to school.	She **went** to school.	The past simple of *go* is *went*.
I **have saw** a lion.	I **have seen** a lion.	After *have*, use *seen*.
They **has eaten** lunch.	They **have eaten** lunch.	Use *have* with *they*.
He **has wrote** a story.	He **has written** a story.	After *has*, use *written*.
We **did went** home.	We **went** home.	Do not use *did* before *went* in an affirmative statement.
She **did not went** to class.	She **did not go** to class.	After *did not*, use the base form.

5. Worked examples

Example 1: Complete the sentence. “Yesterday, the farmer _____ (bring) bananas.”

Step 1: The word *yesterday* shows a completed past action.
Step 2: The past simple of *bring* is *brought*.
Answer: Yesterday, the farmer **brought** bananas.

Example 2: Complete the sentence. “The girls have _____ (sing) the song.”

Step 1: The sentence contains *have*.
Step 2: Use the past participle of *sing*: *sung*.
Answer: The girls have **sung** the song.

Example 3: Correct the mistake. “John has ate his posho.”

The form after *has* must be the past participle, *eaten*.
Answer: John has **eaten** his posho.

6. Practice exercises

Write neatly in the spaces provided. Try the exercises before looking at your notes.

Exercise A: Complete the verb forms (Questions 1–6)

Write the missing form.

No.	Base form	Past simple	Past participle
1	go	_____	gone
2	eat	ate	_____
3	_____	wrote	written
4	see	_____	seen
5	bring	brought	_____
6	sing	_____	sung

Exercise B: Choose the correct form (Questions 7–12)

Circle the correct word. Then write the completed sentence.

7. Yesterday, Ruth (drank / drunk) clean water.

8. We have (saw / seen) the new classroom.

9. The pupils (took / taken) their books last Monday.

10. Peter has (broke / broken) his pencil.

11. The children (ran / run) to the field yesterday.

12. Mother had (went / gone) to the shop before I arrived.

Exercise C: Fill in the blanks (Questions 13–18)

Use the correct form of the verb in brackets.

13. Last night, the baby _____ (fall) asleep early.

14. Our class has _____ (begin) the reading lesson.

15. I _____ (find) a ruler under the desk yesterday.

16. The boys have _____ (do) their homework.

17. Before the match started, the captain had _____ (give) instructions.

18. Last term, our teacher _____ (teach) us a song.

Exercise D: Correct the sentences (Questions 19–22)

Rewrite each sentence correctly.

19. She has wrote the answer.

20. Yesterday, I goed to the borehole.

21. We have drank all the water.

22. He did not took the mangoes.

Exercise E: Write your own sentences (Questions 23–26)

23. Write a sentence using the **past simple** of *buy*.

24. Write a sentence using **has + past participle** of *take*.

25. Write a sentence using **have + past participle** of *see*.

26. Write a sentence using **had + past participle** of *write*.

7. Check what you know

Tick the boxes when you can do these things.

- ☐ I can explain what an irregular verb is.
- ☐ I can give five irregular verbs and their three forms.

- ☐
  I can use *went* correctly for a past action.
- ☐
  I can use *gone* correctly after *has*, *have* or *had*.

Remember: *went* is the past simple of *go*. *Gone* is its past participle. Learn the three forms together.